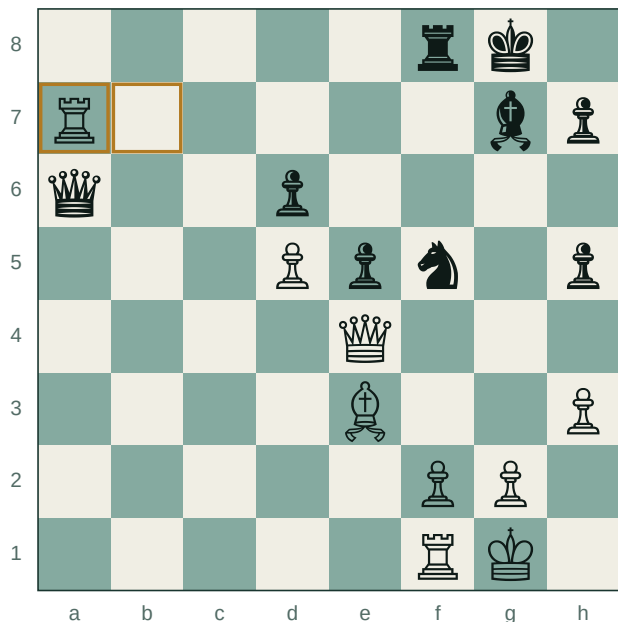


Pins and pressure: Black, move 24

Pins and pressure

Black to move



Previous move: 24.Rxa7. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

24...Qxf1+ 25. Kxf1 Ng3+ 26. Ke1 Nxe4

24...Qxf1+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f1. Recorded reply: **25.Kxf1**.

25...Ng3+ Check restricts White to 2 legal replies here. From g3 it attacks king on f1 and queen on e4. Recorded reply: **26.Ke1**.

26...Nxe4 The knight captures the queen on e4.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 15 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, Black's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does Black's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -2 to +3. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A pinned piece can sometimes move along the line, capture the pinning piece, or answer with a forcing resource.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A pin limits a piece because moving it exposes a more important target. A pin to the king restricts legality; a pin to another piece changes the practical cost of moving.

HOW TO LOOK

Trace the line through attacker, pinned piece, and rear target. Test whether the pinned piece is being counted as a defender it cannot really be.

The defending king is on g1. Geometrically undefended: queen on e4. Check for tactical protection.